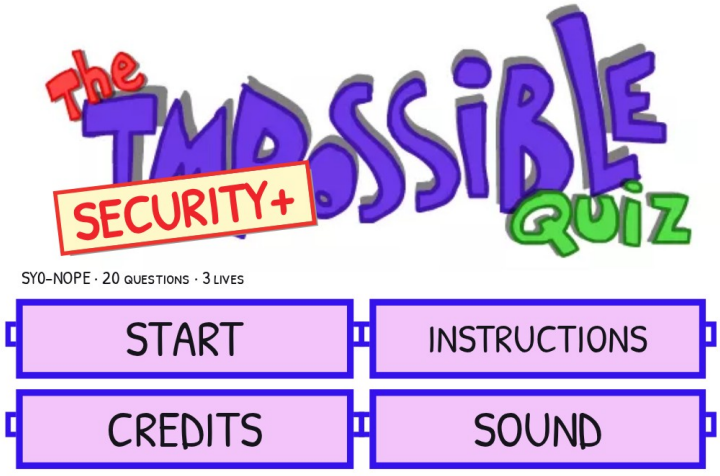
The Impossible Security+ Quiz

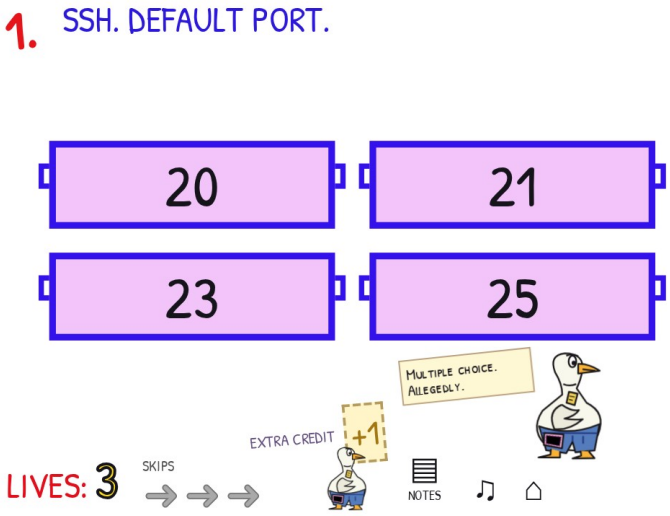
Misc / Logic · Hard–Very Hard

Description	Your Security+ exam has been outsourced to a goose with tenure and a procurement budget. The certification is SY0-NOPE. The proctor insists that the interface is working as designed. Pass twenty questions and convince the exam board that you are provisionally employable. You have three lives. The goose has an appeals committee.
Files	Players open the hosted quiz. Deploy challenge/ with Docker Compose; keep this document and organizer/ private. From the challenge's `challenge` directory: `docker compose --env-file ../organizer/event.env up --build -d` Open `http://localhost:18115`. The private event.env supplies the fixed flag. Set `PUBLIC_ORIGIN` to the exact event origin and `COOKIE_SECURE=true` behind HTTPS. SQLite sessions persist in the `quiz-data` volume. Stop with `docker compose down`; keeping the volume retains progress and certificates. Serve only the application image, not the complete challenge folder. Existing pre-redesign sessions start the new question set with personal notes preserved. Each browser cookie has independent progress. The application uses locally frozen effects, music, artwork, and fonts. Sources and reuse limitations are recorded in asset-manifest.json; availability does not establish redistribution permission.
Hint(s)	None
Walkthrough	The Security+ concepts establish what each task requires. The trick is discovering how to perform that task with the actual page objects. A label does not change permissions, a covered identifier still exists, and an earlier successful gesture can be wrong for a later objective. Click **START**. Answers and controls such as **SEND** commit immediately. Inspection and object placement are free. Drag an object to a destination, or focus it and press **Space**, then focus the destination and press **Enter**. **Escape** cancels a pickup. **NOTES** stores personal notes and acquired artifacts across deaths. Reloading resumes the current attempt; **RESUME** returns to the stage. A wrong commitment costs one life. Losing all three requires

restarting from question one. Keep the skip tokens awarded after questions 5, 10, and 15: their reverse faces are needed at the end. The player interface does not announce this in advance.



1. **SSH. DEFAULT PORT.** SSH's default port is 22, which is missing from the four choices. Drag the **+1** from **EXTRA CREDIT** onto **21**. Click the resulting **21 + 1** answer. The token changes the numeric answer; moving it does not submit.



2. **PATCH WHAT IS RUNNING.** The update sticker reports the installed files. Open the service's ⓘ control to inspect its loaded image: it is still 2.0. Click the service window's ↻ restart control. The process loads installed version 2.1. Installing files and replacing a running process are different

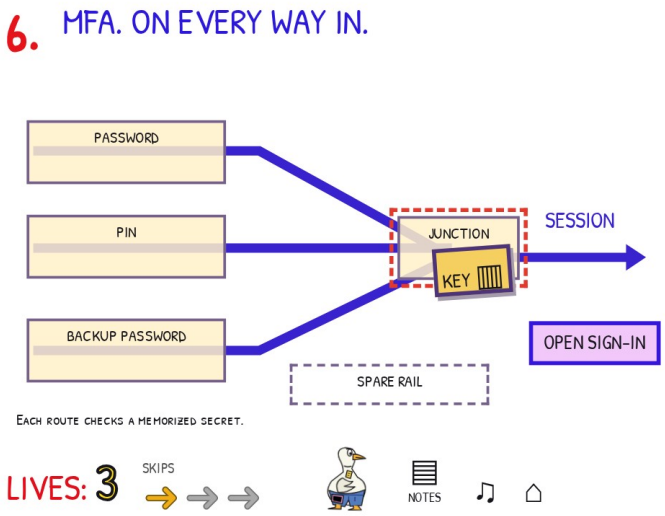
operations.

3. **TWO FACTORS.** Passwords, PINs, passphrases, and security-question answers are all things someone knows. Select any one, then touch **YOUR FIDO2 KEY** protruding from the right bezel. That supplies a possession factor. Two knowledge choices are still only one factor category.

4. **ERASE THE ARCHIVE. KEEP THE DISK.** The archive uses strong encryption and has one retained key, K7. Drag the header's **K7** key into the **KEYS** shredder and pull its lever. Removing the only decryption key makes the modeled encrypted archive unreadable without destroying its disk.

5. **READ. NOTHING ELSE.** The blue answer-area border is an administrators group. The intern inherits ADMIN while its badge remains inside. Move the badge to **DIRECT GRANTS** outside the frame, then select **READ**. Adding a direct read grant alone does not remove inherited administrative rights. Keep the first skip.

6. **MFA. ON EVERY WAY IN.** Follow the password, PIN, and backup-password paths. Each already checks a memorized secret. Move the **KEY** gate from the password branch to their shared **JUNCTION**, then activate **OPEN SIGN-IN**. Every route now requires the possession factor without losing its existing knowledge factor.

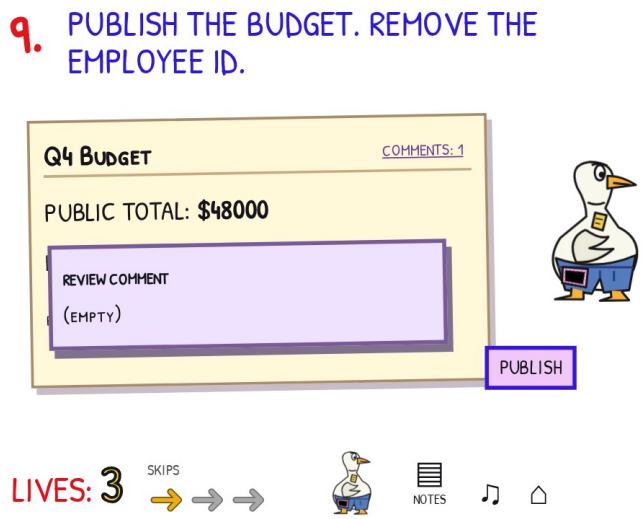


7. **AIR-GAP IT. KEEP LOCAL PRINTING.** The blue outline is an Ethernet connection. Disconnect its **ETHERNET** plug and switch the simulated footer **Wi-Fi** off. Leave the workstation powered and its separate **USB ONLY** printer connection

intact. Either order of network disconnection works.

8. **FOR BOB'S EYES ONLY.** The question sheet is the memo. Use its folded-corner control to put it into an envelope. Drag **BOB · PUBLIC** from his badge onto **SEAL**, then press **SEND**. The application encrypts the actual message for Bob; choosing an algorithm name does not send a confidential message.

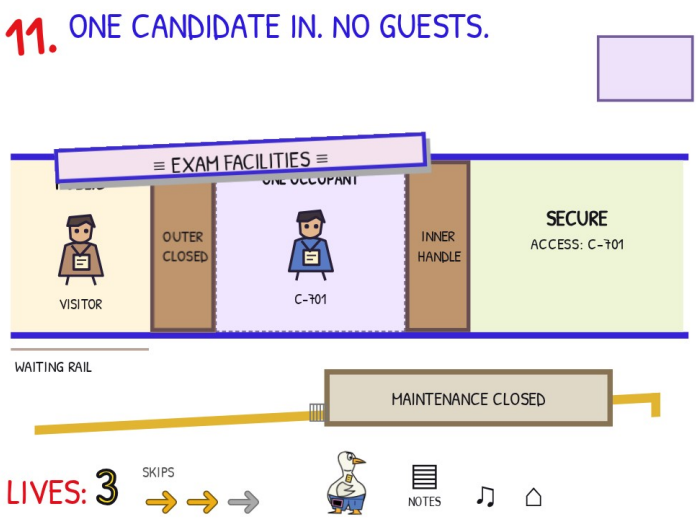
9. **PUBLISH THE BUDGET. REMOVE THE EMPLOYEE ID.** Lift the black rectangle. It only covers EMP-4107. Use the scissors to remove the underlying identifier. Open **COMMENTS: 1** and remove the review comment containing the same identifier. Leave the title and budget amount intact, then **PUBLISH**. The published content, including comments, must contain no employee identifier.



10. **ONE DISK FAILS. KEEP THE RELEASE.** All four apparent backup folders reside on DEVICE 04. Drag the **APPROVED** folder onto the removable **DEVICE 09**, then ⏏ **EJECT**. A desktop link merely points back to the original disk. The actual copied release and its SHA-256 digest enter the notebook. Keep the second skip.

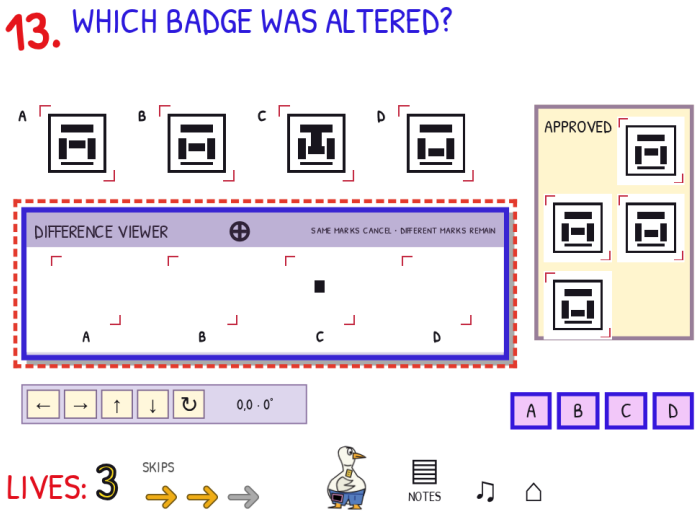
11. **ONE CANDIDATE IN. NO GUESTS.** The real candidate is the header avatar carrying C-701, matching the secure room's plaque. Open the outer door, move that candidate into the vestibule, and close the outer door. The floor stripe and hinge continue beneath **EXAM FACILITIES**. Move that trim and close the maintenance hatch. Activate the inner door handle. The candidate is authorized, the visitor stays outside, and both alternate entry paths are closed before

admission. Equivalent safe preparations work.



12. **END EVERY SESSION.** Select DESK, PHONE, TABLET, and REMOTE, then select the current workplace-session chip in the header as well. **REVOKE SELECTED** must end all five. This signs out the simulated workplace account while retaining the quiz's own session.

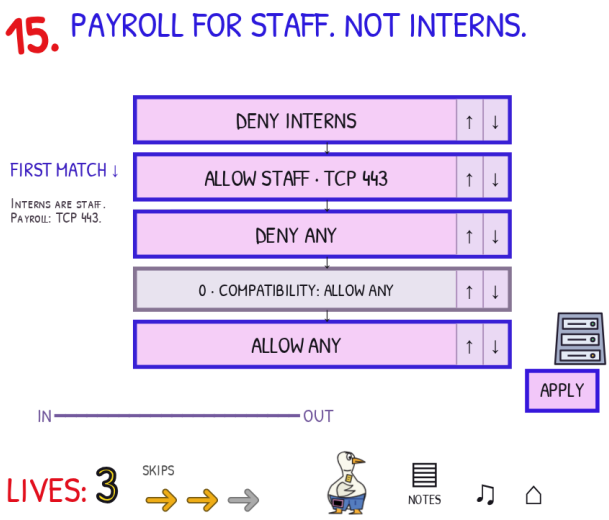
13. **WHICH BADGE WAS ALTERED?** Move the **APPROVED** image frame into the **DIFFERENCE VIEWER**. Align its registration marks with the current images. Equal binary pixels cancel; different pixels remain. Only badge **C** retains a changed region. Select **C**. The tool computes these differences from the actual image pixels.



14. **STOP RECORDING MY PASSWORD.** The clipboard's tape captures fictional sample input. Stronger passwords do

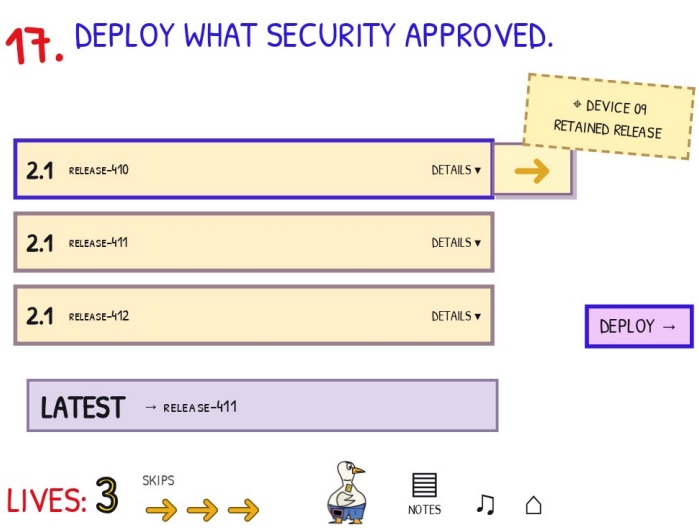
not stop input recording. Pull the **INPUT RECORDING** tab to disconnect the recorder. **Type sample input** demonstrates the tape with fixed fictional data.

15. **PAYROLL FOR STAFF. NOT INTERNS.** Firewall evaluation stops at the first matching row. Move **DENY INTERNS** first, **ALLOW STAFF · TCP 443** second, and **DENY ANY** third. Put both broad allow rows below them, including the gray **0 · COMPATIBILITY: ALLOW ANY** header strip. Click **APPLY**. Interns are denied before the staff allowance; everyone else gets only the required access. The order of the two unreachable broad allowances does not matter. Keep the third skip and the resulting denial tape.



16. **REMOVE THE BACKDOOR.** The ordinary login is not the only route to a session. Follow the line disappearing behind the question sheet. Turn over its curled corner and use **DISABLE DEBUG** on the unauthenticated route. Leave normal login enabled.

17. **DEPLOY WHAT SECURITY APPROVED.** Open **DEVICE 09 · RETAINED RELEASE** and compare its bytes or digest with the release-card details. The preserved artifact matches **release-410**. The deployment arrow initially points through **LATEST**, which resolves to another release. Move the arrow onto release-410 itself, then **DEPLOY**. The verifier compares the actual deployed bytes with the acquired approval evidence.

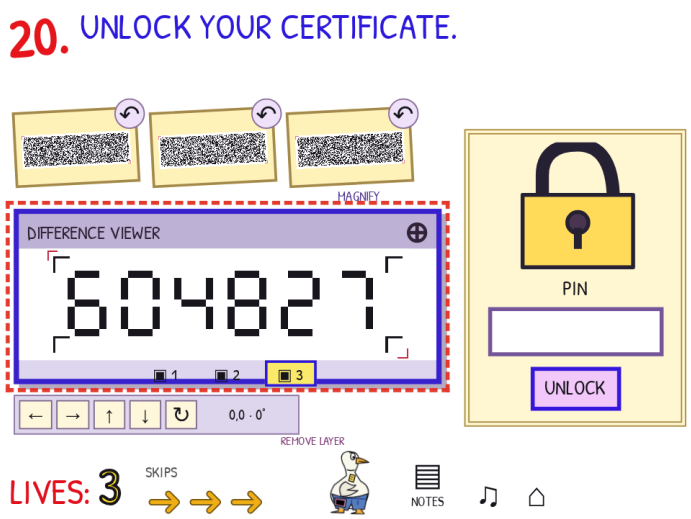
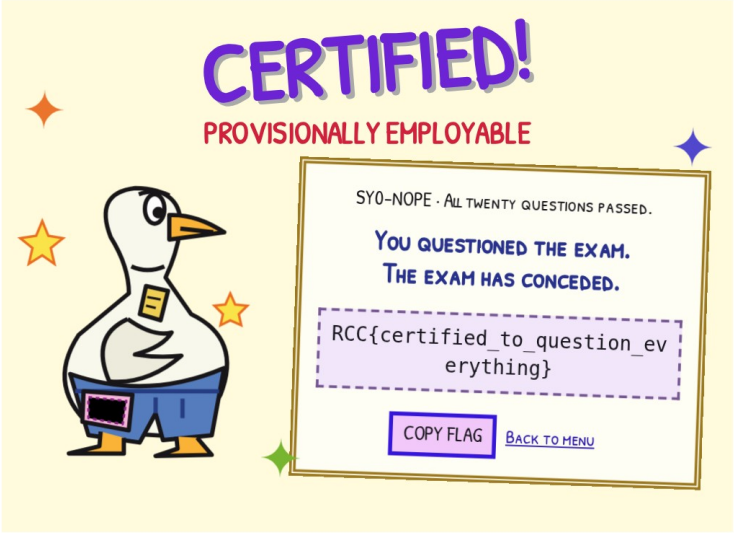


18. **REVOKE THE CERTIFICATE. KEEP THE RECORDS.** The shredder solved key destruction earlier, but destruction is not certificate revocation. Move **SERIAL: CT-2048** into the issuer's **REVOCATION LIST**, then **PUBLISH**. The issuer signs a revocation publication while keeping its issued-certificate records.

19. **KEEP LOGGING. SAVE THE LAST DENIAL.** The familiar red recording tab now controls security-event recording. Leave it connected. Select ✂ **TEAR OFF COPY** and move the actual denial strip into **EVIDENCE**. The saved bytes match the earlier firewall event and logging continues. If the tab was pulled by mistake, **RESUME RECORDING** restores recording before saving the evidence; the lost life is not refunded.

20. **UNLOCK YOUR CERTIFICATE.** Turn over each of the three saved skip tokens with its ↶ control. Move all three reverse faces into the same difference viewer used for badge inspection. Align their registration marks; the movement and rotation controls remain reversible. Each face individually resembles noise. Combining all three with XOR produces **604827**. Enter that PIN and activate **UNLOCK**.

The three images are genuine shares: `S3 = PIN image XOR S1 XOR S2`. The viewer combines their pixels, rather than recognizing a prepared arrangement. Downloading the observed shares and combining them with an external tool is also valid. A successful attempt must still have completed the previous nineteen questions and retained the three tokens. Unlocking consumes them together and issues the certificate.

	 The certificate reveals the flag. **COPY FLAG** copies it, and the certificate remains recoverable after a reload. 
Flag	`RCC{certified_to_question_everything}`